

SettlePath

Complete Minute-by-Minute Dog Independence Training Guide

60 graded plans

1,186 individual minute cues

Pen, room, house-departure and secure outdoor routes

Outdoor progression now reaches one hour

Use the route that matches the dog's real setup. Move up only after two calm results on the same plan. Mixed results mean repeat. Two difficult results mean move down.

Prepared for the SettlePath website and installable app

How to use this guide

1. Choose the correct route. Pen plans use a pen or enclosed safe area. Room/home plans use real doors and house exits. Outdoor plans leave Puppy in a secure private outdoor area while the human goes indoors.

2. Start from the dog profile estimate. Once results exist, the most recently trained plan becomes the recommendation baseline.

3. Use the same scoring rule everywhere. Two scores of 4 or 5 on the same plan move up. Two scores of 1 or 2 move down. Mixed results or a score of 3 mean repeat.

4. Begin only when Puppy is calm. Do not leave during barking, pacing, door-scratching or escalating distress.

5. End early when needed. A timer is never more important than Puppy remaining comfortable.

Route	Levels	Progression
Pen / enclosed area	26	Calm nearby through one hour out of sight.
Room / home departures	18	Room-door separations followed by real front-door departures through one hour.
Secure outdoor practice	16	Human goes indoors for 1 second, 2 seconds, 5 seconds, 10 seconds, 30 seconds, 1, 2, 3, 5, 10, 15, 20, 30, 45 and 60 minutes.

Outdoor route safety: Use only a genuinely secure private area with closed access points, shade, clean water and weather-appropriate shelter. A camera or audio monitor is required. Return immediately if Puppy shows repeated barking, pacing, door-scratching, escape attempts or distress.

Secure outdoor progression to one hour

Level	Plan	Target
1/16	Calm Together Outside	No planned absence
2/16	Step Indoors for One Second	1 seconds out of sight
3/16	Step Indoors for Two Seconds	2 seconds out of sight
4/16	Step Indoors for Five Seconds	5 seconds out of sight
5/16	Step Indoors for Ten Seconds	10 seconds out of sight
6/16	Step Indoors for Thirty Seconds	30 seconds out of sight
7/16	One Minute Indoors	1 minute out of sight
8/16	Two Minutes Indoors	2 minutes out of sight
9/16	Three Minutes Indoors	3 minutes out of sight
10/16	Five Minutes Indoors	5 minutes out of sight
11/16	Ten Minutes Indoors	10 minutes out of sight
12/16	Fifteen Minutes Indoors	15 minutes out of sight
13/16	Twenty Minutes Indoors	20 minutes out of sight
14/16	Thirty Minutes Indoors	30 minutes out of sight
15/16	Forty-Five Minutes Indoors	45 minutes out of sight
16/16	One Hour Indoors	60 minutes out of sight

Room / home departures - Level 1/18

Calm Together in the Chosen Room

Difficulty	Foundation	Target	No planned absence
Session length	8 minutes	Minute cues	8

Best for: Puppy needs to learn that the chosen room is a safe, ordinary place.

Goal: Build calm behaviour before the first full room exit.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Before the timer:

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit beside Puppy in the chosen room and remain quiet for the full minute.	Reward one or two naturally calm moments.
Minute 2	Move your chair half a metre away while staying in the room.	Give a treat after Puppy remains calm for a few seconds.
Minute 3	Stand up, take two steps toward the doorway, then sit down again.	Reward after you are seated and Puppy is calm.
Minute 4	Walk to the doorway and back without leaving the room.	Reward calmness after the movement.
Minute 5	Stand in the doorway for five seconds while Puppy stays inside the room.	Give a treat after you return to your seat.
Minute 6	Step across the threshold with one foot, immediately step back in and sit down.	Reward a calm response. Make the movement smaller if Puppy follows or cries.
Minute 7	Repeat three doorway movements, keeping part of your body visible at all times.	Reward the calmest repetition only.
Minute 8	Finish by sitting one metre from Puppy while doing something neutral.	Give one final treat for relaxed behaviour and end quietly.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Room / home departures - Level 2/18

First One-Second Room Exit

Difficulty	Foundation	Target	1 seconds out of sight
Session length	10 minutes	Minute cues	10

Best for: Puppy can stay calm while you move around the room.

Goal: Teach Puppy that you can step out for one second and immediately return.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Before the timer:

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly with Puppy in the chosen room. Wait for Puppy to become calm before changing your position.	Give one treat for a calm pause, relaxed body or quiet engagement with a toy.
Minute 2	Move one metre away from Puppy and sit down. Stay inside the room.	Reward calmness after a few seconds. Do not call Puppy to you.
Minute 3	Walk to the doorway, touch the door handle, then walk back to your seat.	Reward only after Puppy is calm again.
Minute 4	Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, leave the room for 1 second, then walk back in.	Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Sit with Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 1 second room exit.	Reward the calm return. If barking increases, use a one-second exit next.
Minute 6	Leave the room for the easier duration of 1 second. Close the door partway if Puppy remains comfortable.	Return before worry grows and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Wait for calm, leave the room for the full 1 second, close the door, then return normally.	Give the treat after calm behaviour, not during barking.
Minute 8	Complete two repetitions: one easy 1 second exit and one 1 second exit.	Pause between repetitions until Puppy is calm.
Minute 9	Leave the room for 1 second once more. Stay quiet outside the door and return when the time is complete.	Reward a calm pause after you walk back into the room.
Minute 10	Finish with one successful 1 second room exit. Walk back in, sit down and remain neutral.	Give one final treat for calmness and end while Puppy is coping well.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Room / home departures - Level 3/18

Two-Second Room Exit

Difficulty	Foundation	Target	2 seconds out of sight
Session length	10 minutes	Minute cues	10

Best for: Puppy manages one-second room exits without escalating.

Goal: Build calm, repeated two-second exits.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Before the timer:

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly with Puppy in the chosen room. Wait for Puppy to become calm before changing your position.	Give one treat for a calm pause, relaxed body or quiet engagement with a toy.
Minute 2	Move one metre away from Puppy and sit down. Stay inside the room.	Reward calmness after a few seconds. Do not call Puppy to you.
Minute 3	Walk to the doorway, touch the door handle, then walk back to your seat.	Reward only after Puppy is calm again.
Minute 4	Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, leave the room for 2 seconds, then walk back in.	Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Sit with Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 2 seconds room exit.	Reward the calm return. If barking increases, use a one-second exit next.
Minute 6	Leave the room for the easier duration of 1 second. Close the door partway if Puppy remains comfortable.	Return before worry grows and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Wait for calm, leave the room for the full 2 seconds, close the door, then return normally.	Give the treat after calm behaviour, not during barking.
Minute 8	Complete two repetitions: one easy 1 second exit and one 2 seconds exit.	Pause between repetitions until Puppy is calm.
Minute 9	Leave the room for 2 seconds once more. Stay quiet outside the door and return when the time is complete.	Reward a calm pause after you walk back into the room.
Minute 10	Finish with one successful 2 seconds room exit. Walk back in, sit down and remain neutral.	Give one final treat for calmness and end while Puppy is coping well.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Room / home departures - Level 4/18

Five-Second Room Exit

Difficulty	Foundation	Target	5 seconds out of sight
Session length	10 minutes	Minute cues	10

Best for: Puppy manages two-second exits and calm returns.

Goal: Teach Puppy to remain calm while the door is closed for five seconds.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Before the timer:

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly with Puppy in the chosen room. Wait for Puppy to become calm before changing your position.	Give one treat for a calm pause, relaxed body or quiet engagement with a toy.
Minute 2	Move one metre away from Puppy and sit down. Stay inside the room.	Reward calmness after a few seconds. Do not call Puppy to you.
Minute 3	Walk to the doorway, touch the door handle, then walk back to your seat.	Reward only after Puppy is calm again.
Minute 4	Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, leave the room for 5 seconds, then walk back in.	Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Sit with Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 5 seconds room exit.	Reward the calm return. If barking increases, use a one-second exit next.
Minute 6	Leave the room for the easier duration of 2 seconds. Close the door partway if Puppy remains comfortable.	Return before worry grows and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Wait for calm, leave the room for the full 5 seconds, close the door, then return normally.	Give the treat after calm behaviour, not during barking.
Minute 8	Complete two repetitions: one easy 2 seconds exit and one 5 seconds exit.	Pause between repetitions until Puppy is calm.
Minute 9	Leave the room for 5 seconds once more. Stay quiet outside the door and return when the time is complete.	Reward a calm pause after you walk back into the room.
Minute 10	Finish with one successful 5 seconds room exit. Walk back in, sit down and remain neutral.	Give one final treat for calmness and end while Puppy is coping well.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Room / home departures - Level 5/18

Ten-Second Room Exit

Difficulty	Developing	Target	10 seconds out of sight
Session length	10 minutes	Minute cues	10

Best for: Puppy manages five-second room exits.

Goal: Build repeated ten-second exits with calm returns.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Before the timer:

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly with Puppy in the chosen room. Wait for Puppy to become calm before changing your position.	Give one treat for a calm pause, relaxed body or quiet engagement with a toy.
Minute 2	Move one metre away from Puppy and sit down. Stay inside the room.	Reward calmness after a few seconds. Do not call Puppy to you.
Minute 3	Walk to the doorway, touch the door handle, then walk back to your seat.	Reward only after Puppy is calm again.
Minute 4	Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, leave the room for 10 seconds, then walk back in.	Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Sit with Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 10 seconds room exit.	Reward the calm return. If barking increases, use a one-second exit next.
Minute 6	Leave the room for the easier duration of 5 seconds. Close the door partway if Puppy remains comfortable.	Return before worry grows and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Wait for calm, leave the room for the full 10 seconds, close the door, then return normally.	Give the treat after calm behaviour, not during barking.
Minute 8	Complete two repetitions: one easy 5 seconds exit and one 10 seconds exit.	Pause between repetitions until Puppy is calm.
Minute 9	Leave the room for 10 seconds once more. Stay quiet outside the door and return when the time is complete.	Reward a calm pause after you walk back into the room.
Minute 10	Finish with one successful 10 seconds room exit. Walk back in, sit down and remain neutral.	Give one final treat for calmness and end while Puppy is coping well.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Room / home departures - Level 6/18

Thirty-Second Room Exit

Difficulty	Developing	Target	30 seconds out of sight
Session length	10 minutes	Minute cues	10

Best for: Puppy manages ten-second room exits.

Goal: Progress gradually to a calm thirty-second room separation.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Before the timer:

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly with Puppy in the chosen room and begin only after a calm pause.	Reward the first calm moment.
Minute 2	Walk to the doorway and back twice while Puppy remains in the room.	Reward calmness after the second movement.
Minute 3	Leave the room for 5 seconds with the door open, then return.	Give a treat after calm behaviour.
Minute 4	Leave the room for 10 seconds and close the door partway.	Return before worry increases and reward calmness.
Minute 5	Leave the room for 15 seconds with the door closed.	Give a treat after a quiet return.
Minute 6	Wait for Puppy to become calm, then leave the room for the full 30 seconds.	Return normally and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Stay in the room with Puppy for the full minute as an easy recovery.	Reward relaxed behaviour once.
Minute 8	Leave for 20 seconds, return and sit down without excitement.	Reward after Puppy settles.
Minute 9	Repeat the full 30-second room exit with the door closed.	Use a camera if Puppy cannot be heard clearly. Reward calmness after return.
Minute 10	Finish with one easy 5-second exit and a calm return.	Give one final treat and end the session.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Room / home departures - Level 7/18

One-Minute Room Exit

Difficulty	Developing	Target	1 minute out of sight
Session length	12 minutes	Minute cues	12

Best for: Puppy manages thirty seconds behind a closed door.

Goal: Build one full minute of calm room separation.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Before the timer:

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly with Puppy in the room until Puppy is calm.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Walk to the doorway, step out for 5 seconds and return.	Reward calmness after you return.
Minute 3	Leave the room for 10 seconds with the door closed.	Return before distress and reward calmness.
Minute 4	Leave the room for 30 seconds while monitoring Puppy.	Reward calm behaviour after return.
Minute 5	Sit inside the room for an easy recovery minute.	Give one treat for settled behaviour.
Minute 6	Wait for calm, say the cue once and leave the room for one full minute.	Use the monitor. Return early if distress begins to build.
Minute 7	Walk back in calmly, sit down and wait for Puppy to settle.	Give a treat only after Puppy is calm.
Minute 8	Leave the room for 20 seconds and return normally.	Reward the quiet return.
Minute 9	Repeat one full one-minute room exit if Puppy remains comfortable.	Return calmly and reward after a calm pause.
Minute 10	Stay inside the room for a recovery minute without entertaining Puppy.	Reward relaxed independent behaviour.
Minute 11	Complete one easy 10-second exit with the door closed.	Reward calmness.
Minute 12	Finish with one 5-second room exit and a quiet return.	End while Puppy is still successful.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Room / home departures - Level 8/18

Five-Minute Room Separation

Difficulty	Developing	Target	5 minutes out of sight
Session length	12 minutes	Minute cues	12

Best for: Puppy manages one minute in another room.

Goal: Build a monitored five-minute separation in the chosen room.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Before the timer:

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly near Puppy. Begin only when Puppy is calm.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Walk to the room doorway and return to your seat.	Reward calmness after the movement.
Minute 3	Leave the room for 5 seconds with the door closed, then return.	Reward after Puppy is calm.
Minute 4	Leave the room for 10 seconds and return normally.	Reward calmness.
Minute 5	Leave the room for 30 seconds, then return and sit quietly.	Reward after Puppy settles.
Minute 6	Wait for calm, say the cue once, leave the room and close the door. Begin the 5 minutes challenge. This is challenge minute 1 of 5.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 7	Remain outside the room. This is challenge minute 2 of 5. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 8	Remain outside the room. This is challenge minute 3 of 5. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 9	Remain outside the room. This is challenge minute 4 of 5. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 10	Remain outside the room. This is challenge minute 5 of 5. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Near the end of this minute, walk back into the room calmly.	After returning, wait for calm and give one quiet treat.
Minute 11	Sit quietly near Puppy for a recovery minute without creating an excited reunion.	Reward calm, settled behaviour once.
Minute 12	Complete one easy 10-second room exit and return normally.	Give one final treat for calmness and end the session.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Room / home departures - Level 9/18

Front Door Exit for One Second

Difficulty	Developing	Target	1 seconds out of sight
Session length	10 minutes	Minute cues	10

Best for: Puppy is calm with room exits and needs the first true house departure.

Goal: Teach Puppy that the front door closes for one second and you return.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Before the timer:

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly near Puppy in the chosen safe area. Begin only after Puppy is calm.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Walk to the front door, touch the handle, then walk back to Puppy.	Reward after Puppy remains calm.
Minute 3	Open and close the front door while staying inside the house.	Reward calmness after the door movement.
Minute 4	Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, step outside for 1 second, close the door and walk back in.	Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Sit near Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 1 second front-door exit.	Reward the calm return.
Minute 6	Step outside for the easier duration of 1 second, close the door, then return normally.	Reward before worry grows.
Minute 7	Wait for calm and repeat the full 1 second house exit.	Give a treat after calm behaviour, not during barking.
Minute 8	Complete two repetitions: one easy 1 second exit and one 1 second exit.	Pause until Puppy is calm between repetitions.
Minute 9	Step outside for 1 second and remain quiet on the other side of the door.	Return normally and reward a calm pause.
Minute 10	Finish with one successful 1 second front-door exit.	Walk back in, sit down and give one final treat for calmness.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Room / home departures - Level 10/18

Front Door Exit for Two Seconds

Difficulty	Developing	Target	2 seconds out of sight
Session length	10 minutes	Minute cues	10

Best for: Puppy manages one-second front-door exits.

Goal: Build calm two-second house departures.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Before the timer:

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly near Puppy in the chosen safe area. Begin only after Puppy is calm.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Walk to the front door, touch the handle, then walk back to Puppy.	Reward after Puppy remains calm.
Minute 3	Open and close the front door while staying inside the house.	Reward calmness after the door movement.
Minute 4	Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, step outside for 2 seconds, close the door and walk back in.	Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Sit near Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 2 seconds front-door exit.	Reward the calm return.
Minute 6	Step outside for the easier duration of 1 second, close the door, then return normally.	Reward before worry grows.
Minute 7	Wait for calm and repeat the full 2 seconds house exit.	Give a treat after calm behaviour, not during barking.
Minute 8	Complete two repetitions: one easy 1 second exit and one 2 seconds exit.	Pause until Puppy is calm between repetitions.
Minute 9	Step outside for 2 seconds and remain quiet on the other side of the door.	Return normally and reward a calm pause.
Minute 10	Finish with one successful 2 seconds front-door exit.	Walk back in, sit down and give one final treat for calmness.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Room / home departures - Level 11/18

Front Door Exit for Five Seconds

Difficulty	Advanced	Target	5 seconds out of sight
Session length	10 minutes	Minute cues	10

Best for: Puppy manages two-second front-door exits.

Goal: Build repeated five-second departures from the house.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Before the timer:

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly near Puppy in the chosen safe area. Begin only after Puppy is calm.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Walk to the front door, touch the handle, then walk back to Puppy.	Reward after Puppy remains calm.
Minute 3	Open and close the front door while staying inside the house.	Reward calmness after the door movement.
Minute 4	Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, step outside for 5 seconds, close the door and walk back in.	Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Sit near Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 5 seconds front-door exit.	Reward the calm return.
Minute 6	Step outside for the easier duration of 2 seconds, close the door, then return normally.	Reward before worry grows.
Minute 7	Wait for calm and repeat the full 5 seconds house exit.	Give a treat after calm behaviour, not during barking.
Minute 8	Complete two repetitions: one easy 2 seconds exit and one 5 seconds exit.	Pause until Puppy is calm between repetitions.
Minute 9	Step outside for 5 seconds and remain quiet on the other side of the door.	Return normally and reward a calm pause.
Minute 10	Finish with one successful 5 seconds front-door exit.	Walk back in, sit down and give one final treat for calmness.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Room / home departures - Level 12/18

Front Door Exit for Ten Seconds

Difficulty	Advanced	Target	10 seconds out of sight
Session length	10 minutes	Minute cues	10

Best for: Puppy manages five-second front-door exits.

Goal: Build repeated ten-second house departures.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Before the timer:

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly near Puppy in the chosen safe area. Begin only after Puppy is calm.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Walk to the front door, touch the handle, then walk back to Puppy.	Reward after Puppy remains calm.
Minute 3	Open and close the front door while staying inside the house.	Reward calmness after the door movement.
Minute 4	Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, step outside for 10 seconds, close the door and walk back in.	Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Sit near Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 10 seconds front-door exit.	Reward the calm return.
Minute 6	Step outside for the easier duration of 5 seconds, close the door, then return normally.	Reward before worry grows.
Minute 7	Wait for calm and repeat the full 10 seconds house exit.	Give a treat after calm behaviour, not during barking.
Minute 8	Complete two repetitions: one easy 5 seconds exit and one 10 seconds exit.	Pause until Puppy is calm between repetitions.
Minute 9	Step outside for 10 seconds and remain quiet on the other side of the door.	Return normally and reward a calm pause.
Minute 10	Finish with one successful 10 seconds front-door exit.	Walk back in, sit down and give one final treat for calmness.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Room / home departures - Level 13/18

Front Door Exit for Thirty Seconds

Difficulty	Advanced	Target	30 seconds out of sight
Session length	10 minutes	Minute cues	10

Best for: Puppy manages ten-second front-door exits.

Goal: Progress gradually to thirty seconds outside the house.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Before the timer:

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly near Puppy and begin only after a calm pause.	Reward the calm start.
Minute 2	Walk to the front door, touch the handle and return.	Reward calmness.
Minute 3	Open and close the front door while staying inside.	Reward after Puppy stays calm.
Minute 4	Step outside for 5 seconds, close the door and return.	Reward calmness after return.
Minute 5	Step outside for 10 seconds and return normally.	Reward a quiet pause.
Minute 6	Step outside for 15 seconds while monitoring Puppy.	Return before worry increases and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Wait for calm, then complete the full 30-second house exit.	Return normally and reward after Puppy is calm.
Minute 8	Stay inside with Puppy for a recovery minute.	Reward settled behaviour once.
Minute 9	Repeat one full 30-second front-door exit.	Use the monitor and return calmly.
Minute 10	Finish with one easy 5-second exit.	Give one final calm reward and end.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Room / home departures - Level 14/18

One Minute Outside the House

Difficulty	Advanced	Target	1 minute out of sight
Session length	12 minutes	Minute cues	12

Best for: Puppy manages thirty seconds outside the house.

Goal: Build one full minute of calm home-alone practice.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Before the timer:

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly near Puppy until Puppy is calm.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Walk to the front door and return.	Reward calmness.
Minute 3	Open and close the front door while staying inside.	Reward after calm behaviour.
Minute 4	Step outside for 10 seconds and return normally.	Reward calmness.
Minute 5	Step outside for 30 seconds while monitoring Puppy.	Return before worry grows and reward calmness.
Minute 6	Wait for calm, say the cue once and step outside for one full minute.	Use the monitor. Return early if distress escalates.
Minute 7	Walk back in calmly, sit down and wait for Puppy to settle.	Give a treat only after calmness.
Minute 8	Complete one 20-second exit.	Reward calmness after return.
Minute 9	Repeat one full one-minute house exit if Puppy remains comfortable.	Return calmly and reward after a quiet pause.
Minute 10	Remain inside for an easy recovery minute.	Reward relaxed independent behaviour.
Minute 11	Complete one 10-second exit.	Reward calmness.
Minute 12	Finish with one 5-second exit and a quiet return.	End while Puppy is successful.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Room / home departures - Level 15/18

Five Minutes Home Alone

Difficulty	Advanced	Target	5 minutes out of sight
Session length	12 minutes	Minute cues	12

Best for: Puppy manages one minute outside the house.

Goal: Build a monitored five-minute home departure.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Before the timer:

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly near Puppy. Begin only when Puppy is calm.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Walk to the front door, touch the handle, then return to Puppy.	Reward after Puppy remains calm.
Minute 3	Open and close the front door while staying inside.	Reward calmness after the door movement.
Minute 4	Step outside for 5 seconds, close the door, then return.	Reward a calm return.
Minute 5	Step outside for 30 seconds, return and sit down quietly.	Reward after Puppy settles.
Minute 6	Wait for calm, say the cue once, step through the front door and close it. Begin the 5 minutes challenge. This is challenge minute 1 of 5.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 7	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 2 of 5. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 8	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 3 of 5. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 9	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 4 of 5. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 10	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 5 of 5. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Near the end of this minute, walk back into the house calmly.	After returning, wait for calm and give one quiet treat.
Minute 11	Sit quietly near Puppy for a recovery minute without creating an excited reunion.	Reward calm, settled behaviour once.
Minute 12	Complete one easy 10-second front-door exit and return normally.	Give one final treat for calmness and end the session.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Room / home departures - Level 16/18

Ten Minutes Home Alone

Difficulty	Advanced	Target	10 minutes out of sight
Session length	17 minutes	Minute cues	17

Best for: Puppy manages five minutes home alone.

Goal: Build a monitored ten-minute home departure.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Before the timer:

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly near Puppy. Begin only when Puppy is calm.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Walk to the front door, touch the handle, then return to Puppy.	Reward after Puppy remains calm.
Minute 3	Open and close the front door while staying inside.	Reward calmness after the door movement.
Minute 4	Step outside for 5 seconds, close the door, then return.	Reward a calm return.
Minute 5	Step outside for 30 seconds, return and sit down quietly.	Reward after Puppy settles.
Minute 6	Wait for calm, say the cue once, step through the front door and close it. Begin the 10 minutes challenge. This is challenge minute 1 of 10.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 7	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 2 of 10. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 8	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 3 of 10. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 9	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 4 of 10. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 10	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 5 of 10. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 11	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 6 of 10. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 12	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 7 of 10. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 13	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 8 of 10. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 14	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 9 of 10. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 15	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 10 of 10. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Near the end of this minute, walk back into the house calmly.	After returning, wait for calm and give one quiet treat.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 16	Sit quietly near Puppy for a recovery minute without creating an excited reunion.	Reward calm, settled behaviour once.
Minute 17	Complete one easy 10-second front-door exit and return normally.	Give one final treat for calmness and end the session.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Room / home departures - Level 17/18

Thirty Minutes Home Alone

Difficulty	Advanced	Target	30 minutes out of sight
Session length	37 minutes	Minute cues	37

Best for: Puppy manages ten minutes home alone without distress.

Goal: Build a future thirty-minute home departure one minute at a time.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Before the timer:

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly near Puppy. Begin only when Puppy is calm.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Walk to the front door, touch the handle, then return to Puppy.	Reward after Puppy remains calm.
Minute 3	Open and close the front door while staying inside.	Reward calmness after the door movement.
Minute 4	Step outside for 5 seconds, close the door, then return.	Reward a calm return.
Minute 5	Step outside for 30 seconds, return and sit down quietly.	Reward after Puppy settles.
Minute 6	Wait for calm, say the cue once, step through the front door and close it. Begin the 30 minutes challenge. This is challenge minute 1 of 30.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 7	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 2 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 8	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 3 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 9	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 4 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 10	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 5 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 11	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 6 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 12	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 7 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 13	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 8 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 14	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 9 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 15	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 10 of 30. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 36	Sit quietly near Puppy for a recovery minute without creating an excited reunion.	Reward calm, settled behaviour once.
Minute 37	Complete one easy 10-second front-door exit and return normally.	Give one final treat for calmness and end the session.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Room / home departures - Level 18/18

One Hour Home Alone

Difficulty	Advanced	Target	60 minutes out of sight
Session length	67 minutes	Minute cues	67

Best for: Puppy is older and consistently comfortable with thirty-minute departures.

Goal: Build a future one-hour home departure with continuous monitoring.

Calm cue: Only leave when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', then leave and return without excitement.

Safety: Use a genuinely Puppy-safe room or home area. Remove hazards, secure doors and windows, and use a camera or audio monitor for closed-door or front-door practice.

Before the timer:

- Use a hazard-free room with a comfortable resting place
- Prepare small treats before the session
- Use a camera or audio monitor when the door is fully closed or you leave the house

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly near Puppy. Begin only when Puppy is calm.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Walk to the front door, touch the handle, then return to Puppy.	Reward after Puppy remains calm.
Minute 3	Open and close the front door while staying inside.	Reward calmness after the door movement.
Minute 4	Step outside for 5 seconds, close the door, then return.	Reward a calm return.
Minute 5	Step outside for 30 seconds, return and sit down quietly.	Reward after Puppy settles.
Minute 6	Wait for calm, say the cue once, step through the front door and close it. Begin the 60 minutes challenge. This is challenge minute 1 of 60.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 7	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 2 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 8	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 3 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 9	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 4 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 10	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 5 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 11	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 6 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 12	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 7 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 13	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 8 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 14	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 9 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 15	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 10 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 56	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 51 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 57	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 52 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 58	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 53 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 59	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 54 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 60	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 55 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 61	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 56 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 62	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 57 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 63	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 58 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 64	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 59 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Do not return because of mild attention-seeking noise. Return early if distress is escalating or Puppy is unsafe.
Minute 65	Remain outside the house. This is challenge minute 60 of 60. Use the monitor to check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment. Near the end of this minute, walk back into the house calmly.	After returning, wait for calm and give one quiet treat.
Minute 66	Sit quietly near Puppy for a recovery minute without creating an excited reunion.	Reward calm, settled behaviour once.
Minute 67	Complete one easy 10-second front-door exit and return normally.	Give one final treat for calmness and end the session.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous room/home plan.

Secure outdoor practice - Level 1/16

Calm Together Outside

Difficulty	Foundation	Target	No planned absence
Session length	8 minutes	Minute cues	8

Best for: Puppy needs to feel calm in the secure outdoor area while you remain outside.

Goal: Build calm outdoor behaviour before the first full indoor disappearance.

Calm cue: Only go indoors when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', close the door, return without excitement and give the treat only after calm behaviour.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and clean water. Use a camera or audio monitor for every indoor absence. Stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts, destructive behaviour or distress increases.

Before the timer:

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide shade, clean water and weather-appropriate shelter
- Prepare small treats and position a camera or audio monitor before starting

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly outside with Puppy and wait for a calm pause.	Reward relaxed behaviour once.
Minute 2	Move one metre away from Puppy while remaining outside.	Reward calmness after a few seconds.
Minute 3	Walk to the indoor door, touch the handle and walk back to Puppy.	Reward calmness after the movement.
Minute 4	Open and close the indoor door while remaining outside with Puppy.	Reward a calm response.
Minute 5	Stand in the doorway for five seconds while Puppy remains outside.	Return to Puppy and reward calmness.
Minute 6	Step one foot indoors while keeping the door open and your body visible.	Step back outside and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Repeat three doorway movements without fully disappearing.	Reward the calmest repetition.
Minute 8	Finish by sitting two metres away from Puppy outside.	Give one final treat for relaxed behaviour and end quietly.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results on this same plan. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan; mixed results mean repeat this plan.

Secure outdoor practice - Level 2/16

Step Indoors for One Second

Difficulty	Foundation	Target	1 seconds out of sight
Session length	10 minutes	Minute cues	10

Best for: Puppy remains calm while you move toward the indoor door.

Goal: Teach Puppy that you can go indoors for one second and return outside.

Calm cue: Only go indoors when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', close the door, return without excitement and give the treat only after calm behaviour.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and clean water. Use a camera or audio monitor for every indoor absence. Stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts, destructive behaviour or distress increases.

Before the timer:

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide shade, clean water and weather-appropriate shelter
- Prepare small treats and position a camera or audio monitor before starting

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly outside with Puppy. Begin only when Puppy is calm.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Walk to the indoor door and back while Puppy remains outside.	Reward calmness after the movement.
Minute 3	Step indoors but keep the door open and part of your body visible, then step back outside.	Reward a calm response.
Minute 4	Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, go indoors for 1 second, close the door and return outside.	Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Sit outside with Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 1 second indoor absence.	Reward the calm return.
Minute 6	Go indoors for the easier duration of 1 second and close the door.	Return before worry grows and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Wait for calm, then go indoors for the full 1 second.	Return normally and give the treat after calm behaviour.
Minute 8	Complete two repetitions: one easy 1 second absence and one 1 second absence.	Pause outside with Puppy until calm between repetitions.
Minute 9	Go indoors for 1 second once more and remain quiet inside.	Return outside normally and reward a calm pause.
Minute 10	Finish with one successful 1 second indoor absence.	Sit outside, give one final calm reward and end the session.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results on this same plan. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan; mixed results mean repeat this plan.

Secure outdoor practice - Level 3/16

Step Indoors for Two Seconds

Difficulty	Foundation	Target	2 seconds out of sight
Session length	10 minutes	Minute cues	10

Best for: Puppy manages one-second indoor disappearances.

Goal: Build repeated two-second outdoor separations.

Calm cue: Only go indoors when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', close the door, return without excitement and give the treat only after calm behaviour.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and clean water. Use a camera or audio monitor for every indoor absence. Stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts, destructive behaviour or distress increases.

Before the timer:

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide shade, clean water and weather-appropriate shelter
- Prepare small treats and position a camera or audio monitor before starting

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly outside with Puppy. Begin only when Puppy is calm.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Walk to the indoor door and back while Puppy remains outside.	Reward calmness after the movement.
Minute 3	Step indoors but keep the door open and part of your body visible, then step back outside.	Reward a calm response.
Minute 4	Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, go indoors for 2 seconds, close the door and return outside.	Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Sit outside with Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 2 seconds indoor absence.	Reward the calm return.
Minute 6	Go indoors for the easier duration of 1 second and close the door.	Return before worry grows and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Wait for calm, then go indoors for the full 2 seconds.	Return normally and give the treat after calm behaviour.
Minute 8	Complete two repetitions: one easy 1 second absence and one 2 seconds absence.	Pause outside with Puppy until calm between repetitions.
Minute 9	Go indoors for 2 seconds once more and remain quiet inside.	Return outside normally and reward a calm pause.
Minute 10	Finish with one successful 2 seconds indoor absence.	Sit outside, give one final calm reward and end the session.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results on this same plan. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan; mixed results mean repeat this plan.

Secure outdoor practice - Level 4/16

Step Indoors for Five Seconds

Difficulty	Developing	Target	5 seconds out of sight
Session length	10 minutes	Minute cues	10

Best for: Puppy manages two-second indoor disappearances.

Goal: Build repeated five-second outdoor separations.

Calm cue: Only go indoors when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', close the door, return without excitement and give the treat only after calm behaviour.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and clean water. Use a camera or audio monitor for every indoor absence. Stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts, destructive behaviour or distress increases.

Before the timer:

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide shade, clean water and weather-appropriate shelter
- Prepare small treats and position a camera or audio monitor before starting

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly outside with Puppy. Begin only when Puppy is calm.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Walk to the indoor door and back while Puppy remains outside.	Reward calmness after the movement.
Minute 3	Step indoors but keep the door open and part of your body visible, then step back outside.	Reward a calm response.
Minute 4	Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, go indoors for 5 seconds, close the door and return outside.	Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Sit outside with Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 5 seconds indoor absence.	Reward the calm return.
Minute 6	Go indoors for the easier duration of 2 seconds and close the door.	Return before worry grows and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Wait for calm, then go indoors for the full 5 seconds.	Return normally and give the treat after calm behaviour.
Minute 8	Complete two repetitions: one easy 2 seconds absence and one 5 seconds absence.	Pause outside with Puppy until calm between repetitions.
Minute 9	Go indoors for 5 seconds once more and remain quiet inside.	Return outside normally and reward a calm pause.
Minute 10	Finish with one successful 5 seconds indoor absence.	Sit outside, give one final calm reward and end the session.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results on this same plan. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan; mixed results mean repeat this plan.

Secure outdoor practice - Level 5/16

Step Indoors for Ten Seconds

Difficulty	Developing	Target	10 seconds out of sight
Session length	10 minutes	Minute cues	10

Best for: Puppy manages five-second indoor disappearances.

Goal: Build repeated ten-second outdoor separations.

Calm cue: Only go indoors when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', close the door, return without excitement and give the treat only after calm behaviour.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and clean water. Use a camera or audio monitor for every indoor absence. Stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts, destructive behaviour or distress increases.

Before the timer:

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide shade, clean water and weather-appropriate shelter
- Prepare small treats and position a camera or audio monitor before starting

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly outside with Puppy. Begin only when Puppy is calm.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Walk to the indoor door and back while Puppy remains outside.	Reward calmness after the movement.
Minute 3	Step indoors but keep the door open and part of your body visible, then step back outside.	Reward a calm response.
Minute 4	Only when Puppy is calm, say the cue once, go indoors for 10 seconds, close the door and return outside.	Give a treat after you return if Puppy is quiet or settles within one second.
Minute 5	Sit outside with Puppy for 15-20 seconds, then repeat one 10 seconds indoor absence.	Reward the calm return.
Minute 6	Go indoors for the easier duration of 5 seconds and close the door.	Return before worry grows and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Wait for calm, then go indoors for the full 10 seconds.	Return normally and give the treat after calm behaviour.
Minute 8	Complete two repetitions: one easy 5 seconds absence and one 10 seconds absence.	Pause outside with Puppy until calm between repetitions.
Minute 9	Go indoors for 10 seconds once more and remain quiet inside.	Return outside normally and reward a calm pause.
Minute 10	Finish with one successful 10 seconds indoor absence.	Sit outside, give one final calm reward and end the session.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results on this same plan. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan; mixed results mean repeat this plan.

Secure outdoor practice - Level 6/16

Step Indoors for Thirty Seconds

Difficulty	Developing	Target	30 seconds out of sight
Session length	10 minutes	Minute cues	10

Best for: Puppy manages ten-second indoor disappearances.

Goal: Progress gradually to thirty seconds outside without you.

Calm cue: Only go indoors when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', close the door, return without excitement and give the treat only after calm behaviour.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and clean water. Use a camera or audio monitor for every indoor absence. Stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts, destructive behaviour or distress increases.

Before the timer:

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide shade, clean water and weather-appropriate shelter
- Prepare small treats and position a camera or audio monitor before starting

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly outside with Puppy and begin only after a calm pause.	Reward the calm start.
Minute 2	Walk to the indoor door and back.	Reward calmness.
Minute 3	Go indoors for 5 seconds, close the door and return outside.	Reward after Puppy is calm.
Minute 4	Go indoors for 10 seconds and return normally.	Reward a quiet pause.
Minute 5	Go indoors for 15 seconds while monitoring Puppy.	Return before worry increases and reward calmness.
Minute 6	Wait for calm, then go indoors for the full 30 seconds.	Return outside normally and reward calmness.
Minute 7	Sit outside with Puppy for a recovery minute.	Reward relaxed behaviour once.
Minute 8	Go indoors for 20 seconds and return.	Reward calmness.
Minute 9	Repeat one full 30-second indoor absence.	Use the monitor and return calmly.
Minute 10	Finish with one easy 5-second indoor absence.	Give one final treat for calmness and end.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results on this same plan. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan; mixed results mean repeat this plan.

Secure outdoor practice - Level 7/16

One Minute Indoors

Difficulty	Advanced	Target	1 minute out of sight
Session length	12 minutes	Minute cues	12

Best for: Puppy manages thirty seconds outside without you.

Goal: Build one full minute of calm outdoor separation.

Calm cue: Only go indoors when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', close the door, return without excitement and give the treat only after calm behaviour.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and clean water. Use a camera or audio monitor for every indoor absence. Stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts, destructive behaviour or distress increases.

Before the timer:

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide shade, clean water and weather-appropriate shelter
- Prepare small treats and position a camera or audio monitor before starting

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly outside with Puppy until Puppy is calm.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Walk to the indoor door and return.	Reward calmness.
Minute 3	Go indoors for 5 seconds and return outside.	Reward a calm response.
Minute 4	Go indoors for 10 seconds and close the door.	Return before distress and reward calmness.
Minute 5	Go indoors for 30 seconds while monitoring Puppy.	Return calmly and reward after a quiet pause.
Minute 6	Wait for calm, say the cue once and go indoors for one full minute.	Use the monitor. Return early if distress escalates.
Minute 7	Return outside calmly and sit down near Puppy.	Give a treat only after calmness.
Minute 8	Go indoors for 20 seconds and return normally.	Reward calmness.
Minute 9	Repeat one full one-minute indoor absence if Puppy remains comfortable.	Return calmly and reward a quiet pause.
Minute 10	Stay outside with Puppy for an easy recovery minute.	Reward relaxed independent behaviour.
Minute 11	Complete one 10-second indoor absence.	Reward calmness.
Minute 12	Finish with one 5-second indoor absence and a quiet return.	End while Puppy is successful.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results on this same plan. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan; mixed results mean repeat this plan.

Secure outdoor practice - Level 8/16

Two Minutes Indoors

Difficulty	Intermediate	Target	2 minutes out of sight
Session length	10 minutes	Minute cues	10

Best for: Puppy is comfortable with the previous outdoor plan and can recover calmly after shorter indoor absences.

Goal: Build a monitored 2 minutes period with Puppy outside while the human remains indoors.

Calm cue: Only go indoors when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', close the door, return without excitement and give the treat only after calm behaviour.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and clean water. Use a camera or audio monitor for every indoor absence. Stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts, destructive behaviour or distress increases.

Before the timer:

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide shade, clean water and weather-appropriate shelter
- Prepare small treats and position a camera or audio monitor before starting

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit outside with Puppy and wait for a calm pause before moving toward the door.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Go indoors for 10 seconds, close the door and return outside normally.	Reward after Puppy is calm.
Minute 3	Go indoors for 30 seconds while watching the monitor.	Return before worry grows and reward calmness.
Minute 4	Go indoors for 1 minute, then return outside and sit quietly.	Reward a calm recovery.
Minute 5	Wait outside until Puppy is calm again. Say the cue once and begin the 2-minute challenge.	Do not begin while Puppy is vocalising or pacing.
Minute 6	Remain indoors for challenge minute 1 of 2 and watch Puppy on the monitor.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable.
Minute 7	Remain indoors for challenge minute 2 of 2, then return outside near the end of the minute.	Wait for calm before giving a treat.
Minute 8	Sit outside with Puppy for a calm recovery minute without constant attention.	Reward relaxed behaviour once.
Minute 9	Complete one easy 30-second indoor absence and return normally.	Reward calmness after you return.
Minute 10	Finish outside with Puppy while you move a few metres away and back.	End after one final calm pause.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results on this same plan. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan; mixed results mean repeat this plan.

Secure outdoor practice - Level 9/16

Three Minutes Indoors

Difficulty	Intermediate	Target	3 minutes out of sight
Session length	11 minutes	Minute cues	11

Best for: Puppy is comfortable with the previous outdoor plan and can recover calmly after shorter indoor absences.

Goal: Build a monitored 3 minutes period with Puppy outside while the human remains indoors.

Calm cue: Only go indoors when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', close the door, return without excitement and give the treat only after calm behaviour.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and clean water. Use a camera or audio monitor for every indoor absence. Stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts, destructive behaviour or distress increases.

Before the timer:

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide shade, clean water and weather-appropriate shelter
- Prepare small treats and position a camera or audio monitor before starting

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit outside with Puppy and wait for calm before approaching the door.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Go indoors for 15 seconds, close the door and return outside.	Reward calmness after the return.
Minute 3	Go indoors for 30 seconds while monitoring Puppy.	Return before worry grows and reward calmness.
Minute 4	Go indoors for 1 minute, then return outside and wait for calm.	Reward a settled recovery.
Minute 5	Say the cue once and begin the 3-minute challenge only when Puppy is calm.	Do not leave during barking, pacing or door-scratching.
Minute 6	Remain indoors for challenge minute 1 of 3 and watch the monitor.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable.
Minute 7	Remain indoors for challenge minute 2 of 3.	Watch for a loose body, calm sniffing, resting or quiet enrichment use.
Minute 8	Remain indoors for challenge minute 3 of 3, then return outside near the end of the minute.	Wait for calm before treating.
Minute 9	Sit outside with Puppy for a quiet recovery minute.	Reward relaxed behaviour once.
Minute 10	Complete one easy 30-second indoor absence.	Return normally and reward calmness.
Minute 11	Finish outside with one calm sit-and-move-away repetition.	End after a quiet pause.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results on this same plan. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan; mixed results mean repeat this plan.

Secure outdoor practice - Level 10/16

Five Minutes Indoors

Difficulty	Advanced	Target	5 minutes out of sight
Session length	12 minutes	Minute cues	12

Best for: Puppy manages one minute outside without you.

Goal: Build a monitored five-minute outdoor separation.

Calm cue: Only go indoors when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', close the door, return without excitement and give the treat only after calm behaviour.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and clean water. Use a camera or audio monitor for every indoor absence. Stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts, destructive behaviour or distress increases.

Before the timer:

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide shade, clean water and weather-appropriate shelter
- Prepare small treats and position a camera or audio monitor before starting

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit quietly outside with Puppy until Puppy is calm.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Go indoors for 5 seconds and return outside.	Reward calmness.
Minute 3	Go indoors for 15 seconds with the door closed.	Return calmly and reward after a quiet pause.
Minute 4	Go indoors for 30 seconds while monitoring Puppy.	Return before worry grows and reward calmness.
Minute 5	Go indoors for one minute and return outside.	Reward after Puppy is calm.
Minute 6	Wait for calm, say the cue once and go indoors. Begin the five-minute outdoor challenge. This is challenge minute 1 of 5.	Use the monitor and return early if distress escalates.
Minute 7	Remain indoors. This is challenge minute 2 of 5. Check that Puppy is resting, calmly exploring or using enrichment.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable.
Minute 8	Remain indoors. This is challenge minute 3 of 5.	Watch for pacing, repeated barking, scratching at the exterior door or escape attempts.
Minute 9	Remain indoors. This is challenge minute 4 of 5.	Return early if distress begins to build.
Minute 10	Remain indoors for challenge minute 5 of 5, then return outside calmly near the end of the minute.	Wait for calm and give one quiet treat.
Minute 11	Sit outside with Puppy for an easy recovery minute.	Reward relaxed behaviour once.
Minute 12	Finish with one easy 10-second indoor absence.	Return outside, reward calmness and end the session.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results on this same plan. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan; mixed results mean repeat this plan.

Secure outdoor practice - Level 11/16

Ten Minutes Indoors

Difficulty	Advanced	Target	10 minutes out of sight
Session length	16 minutes	Minute cues	16

Best for: Puppy is comfortable with the previous outdoor plan and can recover calmly after shorter indoor absences.

Goal: Build a monitored 10 minutes period with Puppy outside while the human remains indoors.

Calm cue: Only go indoors when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', close the door, return without excitement and give the treat only after calm behaviour.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and clean water. Use a camera or audio monitor for every indoor absence. Stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts, destructive behaviour or distress increases.

Before the timer:

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide shade, clean water and weather-appropriate shelter
- Prepare small treats and position a camera or audio monitor before starting

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit outside with Puppy and wait for calm before moving toward the exterior door.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Go indoors for 5 minutes, close the door and return outside normally.	Use the monitor and reward after Puppy is calm.
Minute 3	Go indoors for 3 minutes, then return outside and sit quietly.	Reward a calm recovery.
Minute 4	Wait outside until Puppy is settled. Say the cue once and begin the full challenge.	Do not begin while Puppy is barking, pacing or scratching at the door.
Minute 5	Remain indoors for challenge minute 1 of 10. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 6	Remain indoors for challenge minute 2 of 10. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 7	Remain indoors for challenge minute 3 of 10. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 8	Remain indoors for challenge minute 4 of 10. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 9	Remain indoors for challenge minute 5 of 10. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 10	Remain indoors for challenge minute 6 of 10. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 11	Remain indoors for challenge minute 7 of 10. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 12	Remain indoors for challenge minute 8 of 10. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 13	Remain indoors for challenge minute 9 of 10. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 14	Remain indoors for challenge minute 10 of 10. Return outside calmly near the end of the minute.	Pause outside and give a treat only after Puppy is calm.
Minute 15	Stay outside with Puppy for a calm recovery minute and keep the reunion ordinary.	Reward relaxed behaviour once.
Minute 16	Complete one easy 5 minutes indoor absence and return normally.	Reward calmness and end the session.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results on this same plan. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan; mixed results mean repeat this plan.

Secure outdoor practice - Level 12/16

Fifteen Minutes Indoors

Difficulty	Advanced	Target	15 minutes out of sight
Session length	21 minutes	Minute cues	21

Best for: Puppy is comfortable with the previous outdoor plan and can recover calmly after shorter indoor absences.

Goal: Build a monitored 15 minutes period with Puppy outside while the human remains indoors.

Calm cue: Only go indoors when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', close the door, return without excitement and give the treat only after calm behaviour.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and clean water. Use a camera or audio monitor for every indoor absence. Stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts, destructive behaviour or distress increases.

Before the timer:

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide shade, clean water and weather-appropriate shelter
- Prepare small treats and position a camera or audio monitor before starting

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit outside with Puppy and wait for calm before moving toward the exterior door.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Go indoors for 5 minutes, close the door and return outside normally.	Use the monitor and reward after Puppy is calm.
Minute 3	Go indoors for 5 minutes, then return outside and sit quietly.	Reward a calm recovery.
Minute 4	Wait outside until Puppy is settled. Say the cue once and begin the full challenge.	Do not begin while Puppy is barking, pacing or scratching at the door.
Minute 5	Remain indoors for challenge minute 1 of 15. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 6	Remain indoors for challenge minute 2 of 15. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 7	Remain indoors for challenge minute 3 of 15. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 8	Remain indoors for challenge minute 4 of 15. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 9	Remain indoors for challenge minute 5 of 15. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 10	Remain indoors for challenge minute 6 of 15. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 11	Remain indoors for challenge minute 7 of 15. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 12	Remain indoors for challenge minute 8 of 15. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 13	Remain indoors for challenge minute 9 of 15. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 14	Remain indoors for challenge minute 10 of 15. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 15	Remain indoors for challenge minute 11 of 15. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 16	Remain indoors for challenge minute 12 of 15. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 17	Remain indoors for challenge minute 13 of 15. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 18	Remain indoors for challenge minute 14 of 15. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 19	Remain indoors for challenge minute 15 of 15. Return outside calmly near the end of the minute.	Pause outside and give a treat only after Puppy is calm.
Minute 20	Stay outside with Puppy for a calm recovery minute and keep the reunion ordinary.	Reward relaxed behaviour once.
Minute 21	Complete one easy 5 minutes indoor absence and return normally.	Reward calmness and end the session.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results on this same plan. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan; mixed results mean repeat this plan.

Secure outdoor practice - Level 13/16

Twenty Minutes Indoors

Difficulty	Advanced	Target	20 minutes out of sight
Session length	26 minutes	Minute cues	26

Best for: Puppy is comfortable with the previous outdoor plan and can recover calmly after shorter indoor absences.

Goal: Build a monitored 20 minutes period with Puppy outside while the human remains indoors.

Calm cue: Only go indoors when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', close the door, return without excitement and give the treat only after calm behaviour.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and clean water. Use a camera or audio monitor for every indoor absence. Stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts, destructive behaviour or distress increases.

Before the timer:

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide shade, clean water and weather-appropriate shelter
- Prepare small treats and position a camera or audio monitor before starting

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit outside with Puppy and wait for calm before moving toward the exterior door.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Go indoors for 5 minutes, close the door and return outside normally.	Use the monitor and reward after Puppy is calm.
Minute 3	Go indoors for 6 minutes, then return outside and sit quietly.	Reward a calm recovery.
Minute 4	Wait outside until Puppy is settled. Say the cue once and begin the full challenge.	Do not begin while Puppy is barking, pacing or scratching at the door.
Minute 5	Remain indoors for challenge minute 1 of 20. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 6	Remain indoors for challenge minute 2 of 20. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 7	Remain indoors for challenge minute 3 of 20. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 8	Remain indoors for challenge minute 4 of 20. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 9	Remain indoors for challenge minute 5 of 20. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 10	Remain indoors for challenge minute 6 of 20. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 11	Remain indoors for challenge minute 7 of 20. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 12	Remain indoors for challenge minute 8 of 20. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 13	Remain indoors for challenge minute 9 of 20. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 14	Remain indoors for challenge minute 10 of 20. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 15	Remain indoors for challenge minute 11 of 20. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 16	Remain indoors for challenge minute 12 of 20. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 17	Remain indoors for challenge minute 13 of 20. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 18	Remain indoors for challenge minute 14 of 20. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 19	Remain indoors for challenge minute 15 of 20. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 20	Remain indoors for challenge minute 16 of 20. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 21	Remain indoors for challenge minute 17 of 20. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 22	Remain indoors for challenge minute 18 of 20. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 23	Remain indoors for challenge minute 19 of 20. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 24	Remain indoors for challenge minute 20 of 20. Return outside calmly near the end of the minute.	Pause outside and give a treat only after Puppy is calm.
Minute 25	Stay outside with Puppy for a calm recovery minute and keep the reunion ordinary.	Reward relaxed behaviour once.
Minute 26	Complete one easy 5 minutes indoor absence and return normally.	Reward calmness and end the session.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results on this same plan. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan; mixed results mean repeat this plan.

Secure outdoor practice - Level 14/16

Thirty Minutes Indoors

Difficulty	Advanced	Target	30 minutes out of sight
Session length	36 minutes	Minute cues	36

Best for: Puppy is comfortable with the previous outdoor plan and can recover calmly after shorter indoor absences.

Goal: Build a monitored 30 minutes period with Puppy outside while the human remains indoors.

Calm cue: Only go indoors when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', close the door, return without excitement and give the treat only after calm behaviour.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and clean water. Use a camera or audio monitor for every indoor absence. Stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts, destructive behaviour or distress increases.

Before the timer:

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide shade, clean water and weather-appropriate shelter
- Prepare small treats and position a camera or audio monitor before starting

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit outside with Puppy and wait for calm before moving toward the exterior door.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Go indoors for 5 minutes, close the door and return outside normally.	Use the monitor and reward after Puppy is calm.
Minute 3	Go indoors for 10 minutes, then return outside and sit quietly.	Reward a calm recovery.
Minute 4	Wait outside until Puppy is settled. Say the cue once and begin the full challenge.	Do not begin while Puppy is barking, pacing or scratching at the door.
Minute 5	Remain indoors for challenge minute 1 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 6	Remain indoors for challenge minute 2 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 7	Remain indoors for challenge minute 3 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 8	Remain indoors for challenge minute 4 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 9	Remain indoors for challenge minute 5 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 10	Remain indoors for challenge minute 6 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 11	Remain indoors for challenge minute 7 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 12	Remain indoors for challenge minute 8 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 13	Remain indoors for challenge minute 9 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 14	Remain indoors for challenge minute 10 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 15	Remain indoors for challenge minute 11 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 16	Remain indoors for challenge minute 12 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 17	Remain indoors for challenge minute 13 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 18	Remain indoors for challenge minute 14 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 19	Remain indoors for challenge minute 15 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 20	Remain indoors for challenge minute 16 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 21	Remain indoors for challenge minute 17 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 22	Remain indoors for challenge minute 18 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 23	Remain indoors for challenge minute 19 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 24	Remain indoors for challenge minute 20 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 25	Remain indoors for challenge minute 21 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 26	Remain indoors for challenge minute 22 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 27	Remain indoors for challenge minute 23 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 28	Remain indoors for challenge minute 24 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 29	Remain indoors for challenge minute 25 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 30	Remain indoors for challenge minute 26 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 31	Remain indoors for challenge minute 27 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 32	Remain indoors for challenge minute 28 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 33	Remain indoors for challenge minute 29 of 30. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 34	Remain indoors for challenge minute 30 of 30. Return outside calmly near the end of the minute.	Pause outside and give a treat only after Puppy is calm.
Minute 35	Stay outside with Puppy for a calm recovery minute and keep the reunion ordinary.	Reward relaxed behaviour once.
Minute 36	Complete one easy 5 minutes indoor absence and return normally.	Reward calmness and end the session.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results on this same plan. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan; mixed results mean repeat this plan.

Secure outdoor practice - Level 15/16

Forty-Five Minutes Indoors

Difficulty	Advanced	Target	45 minutes out of sight
Session length	51 minutes	Minute cues	51

Best for: Puppy is comfortable with the previous outdoor plan and can recover calmly after shorter indoor absences.

Goal: Build a monitored 45 minutes period with Puppy outside while the human remains indoors.

Calm cue: Only go indoors when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', close the door, return without excitement and give the treat only after calm behaviour.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and clean water. Use a camera or audio monitor for every indoor absence. Stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts, destructive behaviour or distress increases.

Before the timer:

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide shade, clean water and weather-appropriate shelter
- Prepare small treats and position a camera or audio monitor before starting

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit outside with Puppy and wait for calm before moving toward the exterior door.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Go indoors for 5 minutes, close the door and return outside normally.	Use the monitor and reward after Puppy is calm.
Minute 3	Go indoors for 15 minutes, then return outside and sit quietly.	Reward a calm recovery.
Minute 4	Wait outside until Puppy is settled. Say the cue once and begin the full challenge.	Do not begin while Puppy is barking, pacing or scratching at the door.
Minute 5	Remain indoors for challenge minute 1 of 45. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 6	Remain indoors for challenge minute 2 of 45. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 7	Remain indoors for challenge minute 3 of 45. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 8	Remain indoors for challenge minute 4 of 45. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 9	Remain indoors for challenge minute 5 of 45. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 10	Remain indoors for challenge minute 6 of 45. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 11	Remain indoors for challenge minute 7 of 45. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 12	Remain indoors for challenge minute 8 of 45. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 13	Remain indoors for challenge minute 9 of 45. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 14	Remain indoors for challenge minute 10 of 45. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 15	Remain indoors for challenge minute 11 of 45. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 16	Remain indoors for challenge minute 12 of 45. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 44	Remain indoors for challenge minute 40 of 45. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 45	Remain indoors for challenge minute 41 of 45. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 46	Remain indoors for challenge minute 42 of 45. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 47	Remain indoors for challenge minute 43 of 45. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 48	Remain indoors for challenge minute 44 of 45. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 49	Remain indoors for challenge minute 45 of 45. Return outside calmly near the end of the minute.	Pause outside and give a treat only after Puppy is calm.
Minute 50	Stay outside with Puppy for a calm recovery minute and keep the reunion ordinary.	Reward relaxed behaviour once.
Minute 51	Complete one easy 5 minutes indoor absence and return normally.	Reward calmness and end the session.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results on this same plan. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan; mixed results mean repeat this plan.

Secure outdoor practice - Level 16/16

One Hour Indoors

Difficulty	Future goal	Target	60 minutes out of sight
Session length	66 minutes	Minute cues	66

Best for: Puppy is comfortable with the previous outdoor plan and can recover calmly after shorter indoor absences.

Goal: Build a monitored 60 minutes period with Puppy outside while the human remains indoors.

Calm cue: Only go indoors when Puppy is calm. Say one quiet cue, such as 'back soon', close the door, return without excitement and give the treat only after calm behaviour.

Safety: Use only a secure private outdoor area with reliable fencing or walls, closed access points, comfortable weather, shade and clean water. Use a camera or audio monitor for every indoor absence. Stop if barking, pacing, scratching at the exterior door, escape attempts, destructive behaviour or distress increases.

Before the timer:

- Use only a private outdoor area with secure fencing or walls and closed access points
- Provide shade, clean water and weather-appropriate shelter
- Prepare small treats and position a camera or audio monitor before starting

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit outside with Puppy and wait for calm before moving toward the exterior door.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Go indoors for 5 minutes, close the door and return outside normally.	Use the monitor and reward after Puppy is calm.
Minute 3	Go indoors for 20 minutes, then return outside and sit quietly.	Reward a calm recovery.
Minute 4	Wait outside until Puppy is settled. Say the cue once and begin the full challenge.	Do not begin while Puppy is barking, pacing or scratching at the door.
Minute 5	Remain indoors for challenge minute 1 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 6	Remain indoors for challenge minute 2 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 7	Remain indoors for challenge minute 3 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 8	Remain indoors for challenge minute 4 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 9	Remain indoors for challenge minute 5 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 10	Remain indoors for challenge minute 6 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 11	Remain indoors for challenge minute 7 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 12	Remain indoors for challenge minute 8 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 13	Remain indoors for challenge minute 9 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 14	Remain indoors for challenge minute 10 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 15	Remain indoors for challenge minute 11 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 16	Remain indoors for challenge minute 12 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 44	Remain indoors for challenge minute 40 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 45	Remain indoors for challenge minute 41 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 46	Remain indoors for challenge minute 42 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 47	Remain indoors for challenge minute 43 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 48	Remain indoors for challenge minute 44 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 49	Remain indoors for challenge minute 45 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 50	Remain indoors for challenge minute 46 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 51	Remain indoors for challenge minute 47 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 52	Remain indoors for challenge minute 48 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 53	Remain indoors for challenge minute 49 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 54	Remain indoors for challenge minute 50 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 55	Remain indoors for challenge minute 51 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 56	Remain indoors for challenge minute 52 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 57	Remain indoors for challenge minute 53 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 58	Remain indoors for challenge minute 54 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 59	Remain indoors for challenge minute 55 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 60	Remain indoors for challenge minute 56 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 61	Remain indoors for challenge minute 57 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 62	Remain indoors for challenge minute 58 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 63	Remain indoors for challenge minute 59 of 60. Use the monitor to check for resting, calm sniffing, quiet exploring or relaxed enrichment use.	Continue only while Puppy remains comfortable; return early if distress begins.
Minute 64	Remain indoors for challenge minute 60 of 60. Return outside calmly near the end of the minute.	Pause outside and give a treat only after Puppy is calm.
Minute 65	Stay outside with Puppy for a calm recovery minute and keep the reunion ordinary.	Reward relaxed behaviour once.
Minute 66	Complete one easy 5 minutes indoor absence and return normally.	Reward calmness and end the session.

Success check: Repeat this plan until Puppy completes it twice with a calmness score of 4 or 5. Move up only after two calm results on this same plan. Two scores of 1 or 2 mean return to the previous outdoor plan; mixed results mean repeat this plan.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 1/26

Safe and Calm Beside the Pen

Difficulty	Very easy	Target	No planned absence
Session length	10 minutes	Minute cues	10

Best for: Puppy still cries regularly, but can eat and settle when you stay close.

Goal: Teach Puppy that the pen is safe even when you are present but not entertaining Puppy.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Place Puppy in the pen. Sit directly beside the pen, turned slightly sideways.	Drop 1 piece of kibble for any quiet pause, sniffing, sitting or looking away from you.
Minute 2	Remain beside the pen. Keep your hands to yourself and avoid eye contact.	Reward two or three calm moments. Do not reward every second.
Minute 3	Shift your chair or body about half a metre away.	If Puppy stays quiet for 3-5 seconds, calmly place kibble into the pen.
Minute 4	Stay at the half-metre distance. Stand up once, then sit down again.	Reward after you sit if Puppy remained calm or became quiet quickly.
Minute 5	Walk one step away and immediately return to your seat.	Reward a quiet pause after the movement. Make the next repetition smaller if barking increases.
Minute 6	Sit quietly and do something neutral, such as looking at a book or your phone.	Reward one or two settled behaviours, especially lying down or engaging with Puppy's toy.
Minute 7	Stand beside your chair for 5 seconds, then sit again.	Drop kibble only while Puppy is quiet, even if the quiet pause lasts one second.
Minute 8	Take two slow steps away, pause briefly, then return to the chair.	Reward the first quiet moment after you return.
Minute 9	Return to sitting beside the pen and allow an easy minute.	Give one calm reward, then reduce food so Puppy practises settling without constant feeding.
Minute 10	Finish with 20-30 seconds of calm beside the pen. Open the pen during a quiet pause.	Release Puppy quietly. Avoid an excited greeting that makes leaving the pen the biggest reward.

Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 2/26

Small Distance Changes

Difficulty	Easy	Target	No planned absence
Session length	10 minutes	Minute cues	10

Best for: Puppy manages Level 1 with brief whining rather than escalating crying.

Goal: Help Puppy cope while you move between beside the pen and a few steps away.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Start beside the pen for an easy success.	Reward the first calm pause.
Minute 2	Move one metre away and sit down.	Reward after 5-10 seconds of calm. Return to deliver the kibble, then move away again.
Minute 3	Alternate between sitting beside the pen and one metre away.	Reward calm transitions, not only lying down.
Minute 4	Stand up, take three slow steps, and return.	Reward a pause in crying. If Puppy remained quiet, wait a little longer before rewarding.
Minute 5	Sit one to two metres away for the full minute.	Give one or two pieces of kibble during calm behaviour.
Minute 6	Walk past the pen once without stopping, then sit down farther away.	Reward after you are seated if Puppy is calm.
Minute 7	Move closer for an easier repetition, but do not interact through the bars.	Reward relaxed body language or quiet engagement with a toy.
Minute 8	Move two metres away, stand for 5-10 seconds, then return to your chair.	Reward only after a quiet pause.
Minute 9	Sit at the easier distance and ignore Puppy politely.	Allow Puppy to discover that calmness does not always produce immediate attention.
Minute 10	End beside the pen, then release during a quiet moment.	Use one final piece of kibble inside the pen before opening it.

Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 3/26

Moving Around the Room

Difficulty	Easy-medium	Target	No planned absence
Session length	10 minutes	Minute cues	10

Best for: Puppy can cope with you sitting one to two metres away.

Goal: Teach Puppy that ordinary movement does not mean Puppy must follow you.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Begin seated beside the pen for 30 seconds, then stand.	Reward one calm pause before moving.
Minute 2	Walk slowly around the room while remaining visible.	Approach and drop kibble after 10-15 seconds of calm.
Minute 3	Pick up or put down one harmless household item.	Reward calmness after the small noise or movement.
Minute 4	Sit across the room for 20-30 seconds, then stand again.	Reward only once during this minute unless Puppy is finding it difficult.
Minute 5	Walk past the pen twice without stopping.	After the second pass, reward a quiet pause.
Minute 6	Pause near a doorway but remain fully visible.	Reward if Puppy watches without escalating.
Minute 7	Return nearer for an easier minute and sit quietly.	Reward relaxed behaviour, then allow a short food-free period.
Minute 8	Walk to the far side of the room, pause for 5 seconds, and return.	Reward the first quiet moment after you return.
Minute 9	Repeat a mixture of sitting, standing and walking.	Use unpredictable rewards so Puppy is not waiting for food after every movement.
Minute 10	Finish with an easy seated position. Release calmly.	Open the pen after 1-2 seconds of quiet if possible.

Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 4/26

Extended Calm With You Nearby

Difficulty	Very easy	Target	No planned absence
Session length	15 minutes	Minute cues	15

Best for: Puppy can complete the easiest 10-minute sessions but is not ready for many disappearances.

Goal: Increase total session length without greatly increasing difficulty.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Settle Puppy after practical discomfort. Sit beside the pen.	Reward the first calm pause.
Minute 2	Remain beside Puppy without eye contact or conversation.	Reward quiet sitting, sniffing or lying down.
Minute 3	Move half a metre away.	Reward after 5 seconds of calm.
Minute 4	Sit quietly and reduce food delivery.	One calm reward at most.
Minute 5	Stand, take one step away, and sit again.	Reward a quiet pause.
Minute 6	Move one metre away for 20-30 seconds.	Return to deliver kibble, then move away again.
Minute 7	Come closer for an easy recovery minute.	Reward settled behaviour.
Minute 8	Stand beside the pen without interacting.	Reward if Puppy remains calm while you are upright.
Minute 9	Walk two slow steps away and return.	Reward after calmness.
Minute 10	Sit one metre away and look occupied.	Allow a food-free stretch.
Minute 11	Walk once around the room while visible.	Reward when you return to your chair.
Minute 12	Remain close for a recovery minute.	One small reward for calmness.
Minute 13	Move one metre away again.	Reward after a slightly longer quiet period.
Minute 14	Sit beside the pen but continue ignoring politely.	Do not make the ending obvious or exciting.
Minute 15	Give one final calm reward and release during quietness.	End neutrally.

Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 5/26

The Distance Ladder

Difficulty	Easy	Target	No planned absence
Session length	15 minutes	Minute cues	15

Best for: Puppy can stay calm with you nearby for 15 minutes.

Goal: Practise several distances while keeping you visible.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Start beside the pen.	Reward a calm start.
Minute 2	Move half a metre away.	Reward once.
Minute 3	Move one metre away.	Reward after 5-10 seconds of quiet.
Minute 4	Return closer for an easy minute.	Reward recovery.
Minute 5	Move two metres away and sit.	Reward once during calmness.
Minute 6	Stand at the same distance, then sit again.	Reward calm response to the change.
Minute 7	Walk across the room and return to the two-metre position.	Reward after you are seated.
Minute 8	Move beside the pen for recovery without interacting.	Minimal food.
Minute 9	Move to the far side of the room for 10-20 seconds.	Reward if manageable.
Minute 10	Walk past the pen without stopping.	Reward later, not immediately every time.
Minute 11	Sit two metres away and remain boring.	Allow a food-free settling period.
Minute 12	Move closer, then farther again.	Reward a calm transition.
Minute 13	Walk a small circle around the room.	Reward after a quiet pause.
Minute 14	Return to an easy distance.	One final calm reward.
Minute 15	Release quietly during a calm moment.	Avoid an excited greeting.

Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 6/26

First Disappear-and-Reappear Practice

Difficulty	Medium	Target	3 seconds out of sight
Session length	10 minutes	Minute cues	10

Best for: Puppy stays manageable while you walk around the room.

Goal: Introduce extremely short moments when you are out of sight.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Start beside the pen and reward calmness.	Give one easy success before any disappearance.
Minute 2	Walk around the room while remaining visible.	Reward once after a calm stretch.
Minute 3	Step partly behind the doorway for 1 second, then reappear.	Return calmly and reward a quiet pause. Repeat only two or three times.
Minute 4	Remain visible and sit one to two metres away.	Use this as a recovery minute. Reward once if calm.
Minute 5	Disappear for 1-2 seconds, reappear, then continue walking normally.	Reward after quietness; do not rush directly to the pen every time.
Minute 6	Do three easy visible movements.	Reward the easiest calm repetition.
Minute 7	Disappear for 2-3 seconds once or twice.	If Puppy barks, wait for a tiny pause when safe, return, reward, and reduce the next absence.
Minute 8	Sit nearby without interaction.	Allow Puppy to settle without constant food.
Minute 9	Mix one 1-second disappearance with visible walking.	Reward calmness unpredictably.
Minute 10	End with an easy visible minute and release calmly.	Finish before Puppy becomes tired or frustrated.

Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 7/26

Movement Plus First Absences

Difficulty	Easy-medium	Target	3 seconds out of sight
Session length	15 minutes	Minute cues	15

Best for: Puppy manages visible distance changes and some 1-3 second disappearances.

Goal: Blend normal movement with very brief out-of-sight repetitions.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Start beside the pen.	Reward calmness.
Minute 2	Walk slowly around the room.	Reward once.
Minute 3	Step out of sight for 1 second twice.	Reward a quiet pause after returning.
Minute 4	Sit one metre away for recovery.	One reward at most.
Minute 5	Complete a small visible household action.	Reward calmness after the movement.
Minute 6	Disappear for 2 seconds once or twice.	Reduce difficulty if barking escalates.
Minute 7	Remain visible and sit across the room.	Allow a food-free stretch.
Minute 8	Walk past the doorway but do not disappear.	Reward calm response to the cue.
Minute 9	Disappear for 2-3 seconds once.	Reward quietness after returning.
Minute 10	Come nearer for recovery without touching Puppy.	Reward settled behaviour.
Minute 11	Walk around normally while visible.	One unpredictable reward.
Minute 12	Disappear for 1 second, then later for 3 seconds.	Keep both returns calm.
Minute 13	Sit one to two metres away.	Allow Puppy to settle.
Minute 14	Finish with visible, easy movement.	Reward one calm moment.
Minute 15	Release quietly.	End before overtired crying begins.

Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 8/26

Normal Household Activity

Difficulty	Medium-hard	Target	5 seconds out of sight
Session length	10 minutes	Minute cues	10

Best for: Puppy handles 1-3 second disappearances with only mild protest.

Goal: Make pen time feel like part of ordinary life rather than a formal exercise.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Settle Puppy with a safe toy while you sit nearby.	Reward one calm start.
Minute 2	Walk around and complete a tiny household task.	Reward after 15-20 seconds of calm.
Minute 3	Disappear for 2-4 seconds, then return without making eye contact.	Reward a quiet pause after you are back.
Minute 4	Sit across the room and ignore Puppy politely.	One calm reward at most.
Minute 5	Walk past the pen, touch the door handle, and remain visible.	Reward calmness around the departure cue.
Minute 6	Disappear for 3-5 seconds once or twice.	Reduce to 1-2 seconds if the crying becomes sharper or more continuous.
Minute 7	Return to visible movement and an easier distance.	Reward recovery and calm engagement with the toy.
Minute 8	Carry out another small normal task while visible.	Reward after a longer quiet stretch.
Minute 9	Mix one short disappearance with two easy visible movements.	Reward only one of the three repetitions.
Minute 10	Sit calmly near the pen, then release during quietness.	End neutrally, without a big reunion.

Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 9/26

Short Predictable Absences

Difficulty	Medium	Target	10 seconds out of sight
Session length	15 minutes	Minute cues	15

Best for: Puppy can recover quickly after 2-3 second disappearances.

Goal: Build absences of approximately 3-10 seconds while mixing in many easy repetitions.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Start close and easy.	Reward one calm pause.
Minute 2	Move around while visible.	Reward once.
Minute 3	Disappear for 3 seconds once.	Reward a quiet pause after returning.
Minute 4	Sit nearby for recovery.	Minimal food.
Minute 5	Disappear for 4-5 seconds once.	If Puppy copes, reward calmly.
Minute 6	Complete two visible movements.	Reward one of them.
Minute 7	Disappear for 3 seconds, return, and remain visible.	Reward after calmness.
Minute 8	Sit farther away for a quiet minute.	Allow independent settling.
Minute 9	Disappear for 5-7 seconds once.	Halve the next absence if crying becomes continuous.
Minute 10	Come closer for recovery.	Reward calmness, not excitement.
Minute 11	Walk past the pen and touch the door handle.	Reward calm response to the cue.
Minute 12	Disappear for 3 seconds, then later for 6-8 seconds.	Keep the second repetition optional if Puppy is tired.
Minute 13	Remain visible and boring.	No reward unless needed.
Minute 14	Finish with an easy visible minute.	One final calm reward.
Minute 15	Release during a quiet pause.	End neutrally.

Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 10/26

Mixed Short Absences

Difficulty	Hard	Target	10 seconds out of sight
Session length	10 minutes	Minute cues	10

Best for: Puppy usually settles quickly after 3-5 second absences.

Goal: Build flexibility with different distances and brief absences without making every repetition harder.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Start close and easy.	Reward the first calm pause.
Minute 2	Move around the room while visible.	Reward once.
Minute 3	Disappear for 3 seconds, then remain visible for the rest of the minute.	Reward calmness after returning.
Minute 4	Sit one metre away for an easy recovery minute.	Minimal food; encourage independent settling.
Minute 5	Disappear for 5-8 seconds once.	If calm, reward after returning. If Puppy cries continuously, halve the next absence.
Minute 6	Complete two easy visible movements.	Reward one calm repetition.
Minute 7	Disappear for 3 seconds, return, then later disappear for 6-10 seconds.	Keep your return calm and ordinary.
Minute 8	Stay visible but farther away.	Reward a settled posture or quiet play.
Minute 9	Mix one easy 1-second absence and one harder 5-10 second absence.	Reward only after quietness; do not increase both distance and duration at once.
Minute 10	Finish close to the pen and release calmly.	End while Puppy is still coping, not after a final difficult test.

Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 11/26

Unpredictable Normal-Life Practice

Difficulty	Medium-hard	Target	15 seconds out of sight
Session length	15 minutes	Minute cues	15

Best for: Puppy manages 5-10 second absences without escalating.

Goal: Prevent Puppy from predicting exactly when you leave, return or reward.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Start beside the pen and then move away.	Reward one calm start.
Minute 2	Perform a normal visible task.	Reward after a longer calm stretch.
Minute 3	Disappear for 5 seconds once.	Return calmly; reward quietness.
Minute 4	Sit across the room.	No reward unless Puppy settles particularly well.
Minute 5	Walk past the pen twice without stopping.	Reward later, not immediately.
Minute 6	Disappear for 8-12 seconds once.	Reduce to 3-5 seconds if needed.
Minute 7	Return and continue the task rather than going directly to Puppy.	Reward after Puppy is quiet.
Minute 8	Sit nearby for recovery.	One small reward.
Minute 9	Disappear for 3 seconds, then remain visible.	Easy repetition.
Minute 10	Complete a quiet household task for the full minute.	Reward at the end if calm.
Minute 11	Disappear for 10-15 seconds once.	Only attempt if the previous minutes were manageable.
Minute 12	Return and sit one to two metres away.	Allow Puppy to settle without immediate food.
Minute 13	Mix visible walking with one 5-second absence.	Reward unpredictably.
Minute 14	Finish close and calm.	One final reward inside the pen.
Minute 15	Release quietly during calmness.	No big reunion.

Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 12/26

Bridge to 30 Seconds

Difficulty	Hard	Target	20 seconds out of sight
Session length	15 minutes	Minute cues	15

Best for: Puppy usually recovers quickly after 10-15 second disappearances.

Goal: Practise flexible 10-20 second absences before beginning the dedicated 30-second ladder.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Begin close and easy.	Reward calmness.
Minute 2	Walk around while visible.	Reward once.
Minute 3	Disappear for 8-10 seconds.	Reward a quiet pause after returning.
Minute 4	Sit nearby for recovery.	Minimal food.
Minute 5	Disappear for 15-20 seconds once.	Return earlier if distress escalates.
Minute 6	Stay visible and perform an easy task.	Reward recovery.
Minute 7	Disappear for 5 seconds only.	This easier repetition prevents constant escalation.
Minute 8	Sit across the room for the full minute.	Allow independent settling.
Minute 9	Disappear for approximately 15-20 seconds once.	Attempt this only while Puppy remains manageable; return earlier if crying escalates.
Minute 10	Return and remain visible.	Reward after quietness.
Minute 11	Complete two easy visible movements.	Reward one calm response.
Minute 12	Repeat an easier 8-12 second disappearance rather than adding a longer final test.	End with confidence. The next stage contains the first dedicated 30-second attempt.
Minute 13	Return and sit near the pen for recovery.	Give one calm reward.
Minute 14	Keep the final minute easy and visible.	Do not add a last difficult test.
Minute 15	Release quietly during calmness.	End while Puppy is coping.

Success check: Repeat this level if Puppy is mostly able to eat, pause, sniff, play or settle. Move down a level if the crying becomes continuous, sharper, frantic or difficult to interrupt.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 13/26

First Full 30 Seconds

Difficulty	Advanced - introductory	Target	30 seconds out of sight
Session length	10 minutes	Minute cues	10

Best for: Puppy has completed the 10-20 second bridge stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal: Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 30 sec without escalating distress.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement.	Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause.	Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence.	Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 15 seconds and return calmly.	Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Begin the main challenge. Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. for up to 30 seconds, then return calmly within this minute.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area.	Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 7	Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 10 seconds, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging.	Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 8	Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition.	Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 9	Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention.	Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 10	Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score.	End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 14/26

Steady 45-Second Absence

Difficulty	Advanced - introductory	Target	45 seconds out of sight
Session length	12 minutes	Minute cues	12

Best for: Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal: Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 45 sec without escalating distress.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement.	Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause.	Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence.	Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 22 seconds and return calmly.	Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Begin the main challenge. Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. for up to 45 seconds, then return calmly within this minute.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 7	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 8	Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area.	Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 9	Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 15 seconds, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging.	Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 10	Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition.	Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 11	Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention.	Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 12	Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score.	End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 15/26

One-Minute Independence

Difficulty	Advanced - introductory	Target	1 minute out of sight
Session length	15 minutes	Minute cues	15

Best for: Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal: Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 1 min without escalating distress.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement.	Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause.	Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence.	Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 30 seconds and return calmly.	Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 1. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 7	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 8	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 9	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 10	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 11	Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area.	Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 12	Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 20 seconds, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging.	Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 13	Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition.	Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 14	Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention.	Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 15	Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score.	End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 16/26

Ninety Seconds Out of Sight

Difficulty	Advanced - developing	Target	1 minute out of sight
Session length	15 minutes	Minute cues	15

Best for: Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal: Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 1 min 30 sec without escalating distress.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement.	Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause.	Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence.	Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 45 seconds and return calmly.	Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 2. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 2 of 2. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Return calmly near the end of this minute when the target is complete.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 7	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 8	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 9	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 10	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 11	Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area.	Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 12	Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 30 seconds, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging.	Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 13	Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition.	Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 14	Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention.	Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 15	Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score.	End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 17/26

Two-Minute Calm

Difficulty	Advanced - developing	Target	2 minutes out of sight
Session length	18 minutes	Minute cues	18

Best for: Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal: Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 2 min without escalating distress.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement.	Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause.	Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence.	Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 1 minute and return calmly.	Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 2. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 2 of 2. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Return calmly near the end of this minute when the target is complete.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 7	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 8	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 9	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 10	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 11	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 12	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 13	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 14	Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area.	Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 15	Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 40 seconds, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging.	Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 16	Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition.	Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 17	Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention.	Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 18	Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score.	End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 18/26

Three-Minute Routine

Difficulty	Advanced - developing	Target	3 minutes out of sight
Session length	20 minutes	Minute cues	20

Best for: Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal: Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 3 min without escalating distress.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement.	Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause.	Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence.	Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 1 minute 30 seconds and return calmly.	Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 3. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 2 of 3. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 7	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 3 of 3. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Return calmly near the end of this minute when the target is complete.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 8	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 9	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 10	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 11	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 12	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 13	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 14	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 15	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 16	Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area.	Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 17	Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 1 minute, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging.	Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 18	Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition.	Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 19	Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention.	Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 20	Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score.	End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 19/26

Five-Minute Independence

Difficulty	Advanced - moderate	Target	5 minutes out of sight
Session length	25 minutes	Minute cues	25

Best for: Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal: Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 5 min without escalating distress.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement.	Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause.	Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence.	Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 2 minutes 30 seconds and return calmly.	Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 5. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 2 of 5. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 7	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 3 of 5. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 8	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 4 of 5. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 9	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 5 of 5. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Return calmly near the end of this minute when the target is complete.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 10	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 11	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 12	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 13	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 14	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 15	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 16	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 17	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 18	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 19	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 20	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 21	Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area.	Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 22	Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 1 minute 40 seconds, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging.	Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 23	Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition.	Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 24	Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention.	Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 25	Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score.	End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 20/26

Eight-Minute Household Absence

Difficulty	Advanced - moderate	Target	8 minutes out of sight
Session length	30 minutes	Minute cues	30

Best for: Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal: Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 8 min without escalating distress.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement.	Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause.	Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence.	Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 4 minutes and return calmly.	Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 8. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 2 of 8. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 7	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 3 of 8. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 8	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 4 of 8. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 9	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 5 of 8. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 10	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 6 of 8. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 11	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 7 of 8. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 12	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 8 of 8. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Return calmly near the end of this minute when the target is complete.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 13	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 14	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 15	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 16	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 17	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 18	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 19	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 20	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 21	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 22	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 23	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 24	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 25	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 26	Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area.	Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 27	Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 2 minutes 40 seconds, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging.	Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 28	Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition.	Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 29	Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention.	Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 30	Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score.	End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 21/26

Ten-Minute Calm Alone Time

Difficulty	Advanced - moderate	Target	10 minutes out of sight
Session length	30 minutes	Minute cues	30

Best for: Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal: Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 10 min without escalating distress.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement.	Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause.	Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence.	Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 5 minutes and return calmly.	Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 10. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 2 of 10. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 7	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 3 of 10. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 8	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 4 of 10. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 9	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 5 of 10. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 10	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 6 of 10. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 11	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 7 of 10. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 12	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 8 of 10. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 13	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 9 of 10. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 14	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 10 of 10. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Return calmly near the end of this minute when the target is complete.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 15	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 16	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 17	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 18	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 19	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 20	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 21	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 22	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 23	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 24	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 25	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 26	Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area.	Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 27	Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 3 minutes 20 seconds, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging.	Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 28	Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition.	Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 29	Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention.	Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 30	Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score.	End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 22/26

Fifteen-Minute Independence

Difficulty	Advanced - substantial	Target	15 minutes out of sight
Session length	35 minutes	Minute cues	35

Best for: Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal: Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 15 min without escalating distress. This is a longer future-stage attempt. Do only one full challenge attempt that day; other practices should be short, easy consolidation sessions.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement.	Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause.	Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence.	Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 5 minutes and return calmly.	Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 2 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 7	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 3 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 8	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 4 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 9	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 5 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 10	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 6 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 11	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 7 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 12	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 8 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 13	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 9 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 14	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 10 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 15	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 11 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 16	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 12 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 17	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 13 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 18	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 14 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 19	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 15 of 15. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Return calmly near the end of this minute when the target is complete.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 20	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 21	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 22	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 23	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 24	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 25	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 26	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 27	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 28	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 29	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 30	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 31	Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area.	Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 32	Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 5 minutes, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging.	Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 33	Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition.	Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 34	Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention.	Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 35	Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score.	End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 23/26

Twenty-Minute Independence

Difficulty	Advanced - substantial	Target	20 minutes out of sight
Session length	40 minutes	Minute cues	40

Best for: Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal: Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 20 min without escalating distress. This is a longer future-stage attempt. Do only one full challenge attempt that day; other practices should be short, easy consolidation sessions.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement.	Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause.	Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence.	Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 5 minutes and return calmly.	Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 2 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 7	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 3 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 8	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 4 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 9	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 5 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 10	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 6 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 11	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 7 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 12	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 8 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 13	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 9 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 14	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 10 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 15	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 11 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 16	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 12 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 17	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 13 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 18	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 14 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 19	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 15 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 20	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 16 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 21	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 17 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 22	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 18 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 23	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 19 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 24	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 20 of 20. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Return calmly near the end of this minute when the target is complete.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 25	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 26	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 27	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 28	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 29	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 30	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 31	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 32	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 33	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 34	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 35	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 36	Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area.	Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 37	Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 5 minutes, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging.	Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 38	Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition.	Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 39	Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention.	Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 40	Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score.	End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 24/26

Thirty-Minute Independence

Difficulty	Advanced - long	Target	30 minutes out of sight
Session length	50 minutes	Minute cues	50

Best for: Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal: Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 30 min without escalating distress. This is a longer future-stage attempt. Do only one full challenge attempt that day; other practices should be short, easy consolidation sessions.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement.	Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause.	Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence.	Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 5 minutes and return calmly.	Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 2 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 7	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 3 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 8	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 4 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 9	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 5 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 10	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 6 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 11	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 7 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 12	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 8 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 33	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 29 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 34	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 30 of 30. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Return calmly near the end of this minute when the target is complete.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 35	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 36	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 37	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 38	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 39	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 40	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 41	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 42	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 43	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 44	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 45	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 46	Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area.	Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 47	Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 5 minutes, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging.	Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 48	Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition.	Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 49	Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention.	Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 50	Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score.	End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 25/26

Forty-Five-Minute Independence

Difficulty	Advanced - long	Target	45 minutes out of sight
Session length	65 minutes	Minute cues	65

Best for: Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal: Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 45 min without escalating distress. This is a longer future-stage attempt. Do only one full challenge attempt that day; other practices should be short, easy consolidation sessions.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement.	Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause.	Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence.	Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 5 minutes and return calmly.	Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 2 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 7	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 3 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 8	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 4 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 9	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 5 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 10	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 6 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 11	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 7 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 12	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 8 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 33	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 29 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 34	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 30 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 35	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 31 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 36	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 32 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 37	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 33 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 38	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 34 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 39	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 35 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 40	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 36 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 41	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 37 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 42	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 38 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 43	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 39 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 44	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 40 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 45	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 41 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 46	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 42 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 47	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 43 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 48	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 44 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 49	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 45 of 45. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Return calmly near the end of this minute when the target is complete.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 50	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 51	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 52	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 53	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 54	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 55	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 56	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 57	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 58	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 59	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 60	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 61	Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area.	Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 62	Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 5 minutes, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging.	Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 63	Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition.	Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.
Minute 64	Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention.	Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 65	Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score.	End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Pen / enclosed area - Level 26/26

One-Hour Independence

Difficulty	Advanced - future goal	Target	60 minutes out of sight
Session length	75 minutes	Minute cues	75

Best for: Puppy has completed the previous stage calmly on two separate attempts.

Goal: Build a comfortable, repeatable out-of-sight period of 1 hr without escalating distress. This is a longer future-stage attempt. Do only one full challenge attempt that day; other practices should be short, easy consolidation sessions.

Calm cue: Say one calm cue, such as 'settle', only when Puppy is calm. Keep every departure and return quiet.

Safety: Use the pen only as a positive safe area. Make sure it is large enough, comfortable, well ventilated and free of unsafe items. Do not continue while distress is escalating.

Before the timer:

- Prepare small treats before the session
- Comfortable, ventilated pen or enclosed safe area
- Water when appropriate and one familiar safe enrichment item
- Camera or audio monitor for real out-of-sight practice

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 1	Sit beside Puppy in the pen area. Wait for a calm pause before beginning the first movement.	Give one quiet treat for calmness, then begin the planned exercise.
Minute 2	Settle Puppy in the pen or enclosed safe area. Stay nearby without entertaining Puppy and wait for a calm pause.	Reward quiet sniffing, sitting, lying down or engaging with the enrichment item.
Minute 3	Walk normally, touch the doorway and say the calm cue once before the absence.	Keep the cue ordinary. If the cue alone causes worry, repeat an easier cue-only plan before leaving.
Minute 4	Complete one easy warm-up absence of about 5 minutes and return calmly.	Reward calm recovery. If this warm-up is difficult, stop and use the previous plan.
Minute 5	Move out of sight while Puppy remains in the pen or enclosed safe area. Start the timer. Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 1 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 6	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 2 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 7	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 3 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 8	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 4 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 9	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 5 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 10	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 6 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 11	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 7 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 12	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 8 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 53	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 49 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 54	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 50 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 55	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 51 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 56	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 52 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 57	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 53 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 58	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 54 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 59	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 55 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 60	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 56 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 61	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 57 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 62	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 58 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 63	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 59 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 64	Remain out of sight. This is challenge minute 60 of 60. Use the monitor to check for a loose body, resting, sniffing or calm use of the safe toy. Return calmly near the end of this minute when the target is complete.	Do not wait for panic. Return if vocalising becomes continuous, pacing increases, food is abandoned or Puppy cannot recover.
Minute 65	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 66	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 67	Sit at an easy distance and allow a food-free settling period.	If Puppy is calm, simply let calmness continue.
Minute 68	Check that Puppy remains comfortable and that the training area is still safe.	Make a note of any subtle signs such as pacing, panting, scanning, freezing or abandoning food.
Minute 69	Remain visible and quietly unavailable while Puppy settles again.	Reward one relaxed choice, such as lying down, sniffing or returning to the enrichment item.
Minute 70	Complete a small normal household movement without starting another difficult absence.	Reward calmness after the movement, not excited following.
Minute 71	Return calmly and continue a normal low-key activity near the training area.	Wait for calm recovery before offering one small reward.
Minute 72	Do one easier consolidation repetition of about 5 minutes, or remain visible if the main attempt was challenging.	Choose the easier option. The purpose is confidence, not achieving another maximum.
Minute 73	Return calmly, wait for Puppy to settle, then complete one easy visible repetition.	Give a treat only after calm behaviour. End while Puppy is still coping.

Minute	Main activity	Reward / adjustment
Minute 74	Stay nearby and allow a quiet recovery period without excited attention.	Reward settled body language once, then keep the reunion neutral.
Minute 75	Finish with a calm, ordinary ending. Record the actual comfortable absence and the calmness score.	End on the easiest successful behaviour available; do not add a final surprise challenge.

Success check: Give this exact stage a calmness score of 4 or 5 on two completed attempts before upgrading. A score of 3 repeats the stage. Two scores of 1 or 2 on this stage mean return to an easier stage.

Training references

These sources informed the gradual progression, monitoring and welfare safeguards used throughout the guide.

Dogs Trust - How to help your dog get used to spending time alone

Build time apart gradually, pair it with positive enrichment, monitor the dog and shorten the next attempt if anxiety appears.

<https://www.dogstrust.org.uk/dog-advice/training/home/time-alone>

Dogs Trust - Separation anxiety: leaving the room

Practise brief out-of-sight periods, increase time gradually and use a camera to check that the dog remains relaxed.

<https://www.dogstrust.org.uk/dog-advice/training/unwanted-behaviours/separation-anxiety>

RSPCA - How to train your dog to stay home alone

Use gradual alone-time training and periodic video checks for hidden signs such as pacing, trembling or quiet whining.

<https://www.rspca.org.uk/adviceandwelfare/pets/dogs/training/leftalone>

Blue Cross - Preventing separation anxiety in puppies

Move at the puppy's pace and return to the last comfortable duration whenever worry appears.

<https://www.bluecross.org.uk/advice/dog/behaviour-and-training/preventing-separation-anxiety-in-puppies>

RSPCA - Keeping dogs outside

Outdoor time requires shelter, water, security and protection from weather, loneliness and distress.

<https://www.rspca.org.uk/adviceandwelfare/pets/dogs/environment/livingoutside>

RSPCA - Caring for dogs in hot weather

Dogs need constant access to shade and clean water in warm weather.

<https://www.rspca.org.uk/adviceandwelfare/seasonal/summer/dogs>